On December 20, I saw some sergeant in the administrative building. There had been reports that no one in administration had heard any such order, and I was selected as the soldier to see and enlighten them, since I had been first and loudest in the field. I had the clipping ready, complete with the number of the order and so on.

I was half afraid that they would tell me the whole thing was a hoax. The sergeant merely said I would need proof that I was in scientific research in civilian life.

Fine! I asked for nothing better. My Christmas furlough started the next day and I would surely be down at Columbia to get whatever documentation was necessary. The thought kept me warm awhile I was indoctrinated into the mysteries of the submachine gun that day.

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Friday, December 21, 1945, was my father's forty-ninth birthday. I spent all day getting home on my second furlough and that was as good

5 At home, meanwhile, Gertrude completed the necessary routine for citizenship. She went to Philadelphia on December 13, 1945, to take the tests, and early in January of 1946 she became an American citizen.

as any other way to celebrate it. I took the train from Petersburg this time and arrived at Union Station in Washington to be greeted with a fearful Christmas rush. Although I had arisen at 5:00 a.m., I didn't get home till 9:00 p.m. and spent the first night of my furlough at Windsor Place.

The next day I rushed to Columbia even though it was a Saturday, and I was fortunate enough to catch Professor Thomas. I arranged to get all the documentation I needed, then rushed to the Henry Paper Box Company to see Gertrude for the first time in twenty days. The proof of research arrived on the twenty-seventh.

The furlough lasted a total of ten days, and by and large it was active in a pleasant way, except for the fact that my father had the flu and ran a bad fever for a day or so. I alternated between Windsor Place and Brighton Beach and saw all I could of Gertrude.

Christmas itself was quiet and peaceful and I spent it serenely reading murder mysteries.